



"Most Donations come from the victims of road accidents. Most of them end up in Government Hospitals, And they must do something to improve the donor pool."

Dr. Sunil Shroff, Founder Mohan Foundation

suturing and faster post-operative recovery, where pain is less, infection chances are rare, scarring is minimal, and hospitalization is drastically reduced cutting costs. There are newer frontiers being explored in medical technology, which would take medicine to another level and achieve unimaginable possibilities.

Donor Criteria

No two recipient bodies behave similarly in accepting an organ of a donor. Meaning that the body reacts differently for different people when it an organ is transplanted in a recipient, which can also be rejected. Each organ has different matching criteria, but broadly the criteria include blood type and size of the organ or organs needed, wait-listed time for a transplant, distance between donor and recipient, besides some vitals factors such as the medical emergency of the recipient, the matching level of immune system between donor and recipient and whether the recipient is an adult or a child. Organ transplantation is the answer to reducing healthcare burden considerably by doing away with the need for hospitalization, undergoing repeat surgeries and prolonged treatment.

Vital Logistics

Many vital factors must be taken into consideration apart from medical aspect of the best-matched donor and potential organ recipient. It includes logistics such as their proximity or distance involved for transporting the organ within the critical time-frame. If the donor and recipient live in the same city the organ can be transported by an ambulance, and if in a different part of the country the organ can be transported by airlines. Heart and lung have only 2 to 6 hours viability, so they have to be transported quickly using fastest transport modes and green corridors created especially for reaching the site on time. Kidneys can be preserved for up to 36 hours before being transplanted, but exceptions are critical medical need of a patient.

Donor Facts

Following the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare removing the age cap that people beyond 65 years could not receive cadaver organ transplants in

consideration of the right to life enshrined under Article 21, everyone can be a donor based on medical conditions, which determine whether or not an organ and tissue can be donated. The Centre has also removed the need for domicile registration to receive organs from a particular State/Union Territory, besides directing them to not charge any fee for organ recipient registration. To streamline and make the facility seamless, patients will be allotted a unique ID by NOTTO on registering having validity even if the patient changes multiple hospitals in different states.

Organ Donation in India

Though India conducts the third highest number of transplants in the world, the number of organs needed is still much higher. The country has an organ donation rate of 0.52 per million population, much lower than other countries such as Spain, which has a high 49.6 per million.

In 2022, nearly 12,791 living donor transplants and 2,765 deceased donor transplants were said to be conducted, while only 1,743 (14%) of the organs were cadaver donors, whereas majority of organs harvested were from living donors, specifically kidney and liver donations. As per data, India, registered 1,589 kidney transplants, 761 liver and 250 heart transplants in the deceased category in 2022. Kidney transplant is the most common followed by liver, heart, lung, pancreas, and small bowel transplants.

A high cadaver donation is achievable in India, if the organs of road accident victims can be salvaged, with nearly 1.5 lakh people succumbing to road mishaps, every year across the country. India ranks at the top in road accident death toll in the world. Also lifestyle diseases are also increasingly impacting people, raising demand for organs, which can be retrieved from deceased donors.

Challenges of Organ Transplantation

Lack of awareness among people about the importance of organ donation and transplantation is the biggest



"Livers from brain-dead patients may exhibit various issues such as fat deposits, damage, compromised blood supply, infections, low blood pressure, etc. These factors can affect the organ's quality and limit their preservation outside the body."

Dr. A S Sooin, Liver Transplant Surgeon



Unlike in other surgeries ,where work of a surgeon ends after he is out of OT; in case of a Transplant Surgeon, the commitment is life long to the organ recipient. They need long term follow up. I am in touch with all my patients.They seek guidance over phone and emails .These things have to be taken care of all patients are from far off parts of the country.

Dr. Mukul Minz, Kidney Transplant Surgeon

challenge. It has created shortage of organs as people are not volunteering to do so because of cultural traditions, religious beliefs, and lack of trust in the medical system which is faced by several legal and ethical issues surrounding organ donation, including consent, allocation of organs, and the fair distribution of organs. Transplantation and preservation, which come with logistic challenges, especially for organs with a small-window of viability needing specific conditions of storage, is another road-block. Medical suitability is another challenge because all donated organs are not suitable for transplantation, which can limit the number of available organs for transplant. Affordability is another important factor, which can be high making transplantation inaccessible for patients with financial constraints.

Some Government Initiatives

- National Organ Transplant Programme (NOTP) launched in 2014, created a national registry of organ donors and recipients, established more organ transplant centres, and propagates public awareness about organ donation.
- Deceased Organ Donation Program launched by Ministry of Health and Family Welfare encourages organ donation from deceased individuals.
- Designated November 27 as National Organ Donation Day to raise awareness about the importance of organ donation and encourage people to pledge to donate their organs.
- Swasth Bharat Yatra campaign aims to promote healthy living, prevent lifestyle diseases, raise awareness on organ donation and encourages people to pledge to donate their organs.
- Organ Retrieval Banking Organization is a part of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi and is responsible for the retrieval, preservation, and distribution of organs for transplantation in the Delhi-NCR region.